Low-Code Experiment

Implementing Security Features and Governance / Administration Practices in Zoho Creator

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Abstract
This experiment reviews the security and governance features of the HOTEL BOOKING application. Access control through permission sets, mandatory-field validation of submitted data and the separation of environments were examined in the application, and further practices such as private form links, account security and activity logs are described as administration guidelines.

1. Aim
To implement security features and governance and administration practices in a Zoho Creator application.

Note on Execution
The lab account's free trial has expired (the banner Trial has expired is visible in the screenshots), and the features used in this experiment need a paid plan. The experiment is therefore documented as a procedure together with the evidence that could be captured in the available account. Steps that could not be executed are marked as such.

2. Concepts
Access security. The User Permissions page defines permission sets that control, module by module, who can access, view, edit and delete records, and the Roles and Data Sharing tabs control record visibility.

Data validation. Mandatory fields on the Room Booking Form (Guest Name, ID Proof Number, Number Of Guests, Contact Number) stop incomplete or invalid records from being saved, and the form refuses submission with the message Invalid entries found.

Governance. Separate Development, Stage and Production environments, consistent naming of forms, fields and workflows, and least-privilege permission sets keep the application controlled and maintainable.

Further practices (documented). Sharing the booking form through a private link instead of an open public link, restricting sensitive fields such as ID Proof Number to authorised users, switching on two-factor authentication for the Zoho account, and reviewing activity or audit logs regularly.

3. Procedure
1. Open Settings and User Permissions to review the permission sets and the Roles and Data Sharing tabs (executed).
2. Open Add Permission and review the Set Permissions table: Access, View, Edit, Delete and More for each module (executed).
3. Open the Room Booking Form in the Design tab and check the Mandatory validation and field link name in Field Properties (executed).
4. Submit the live form with empty mandatory fields and confirm that it is blocked (executed).

5. Create a private link for the booking form, restrict the ID Proof Number field, enable two-factor authentication and review the activity log (documented practices, not executed in the lab account).

4. Implementation Screenshots (HOTEL BOOKING application)

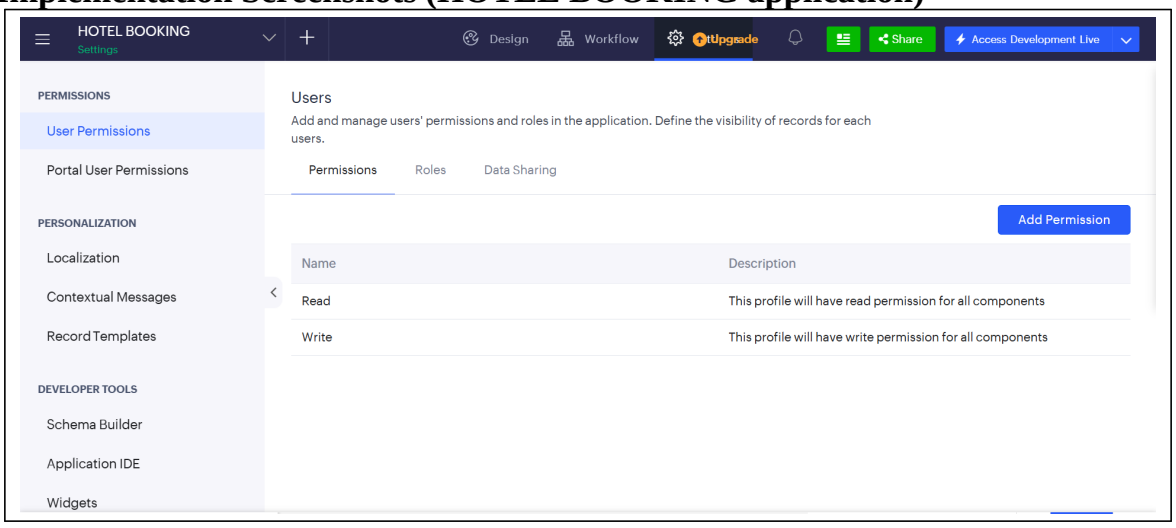


Figure 1: Users page with the Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing tabs

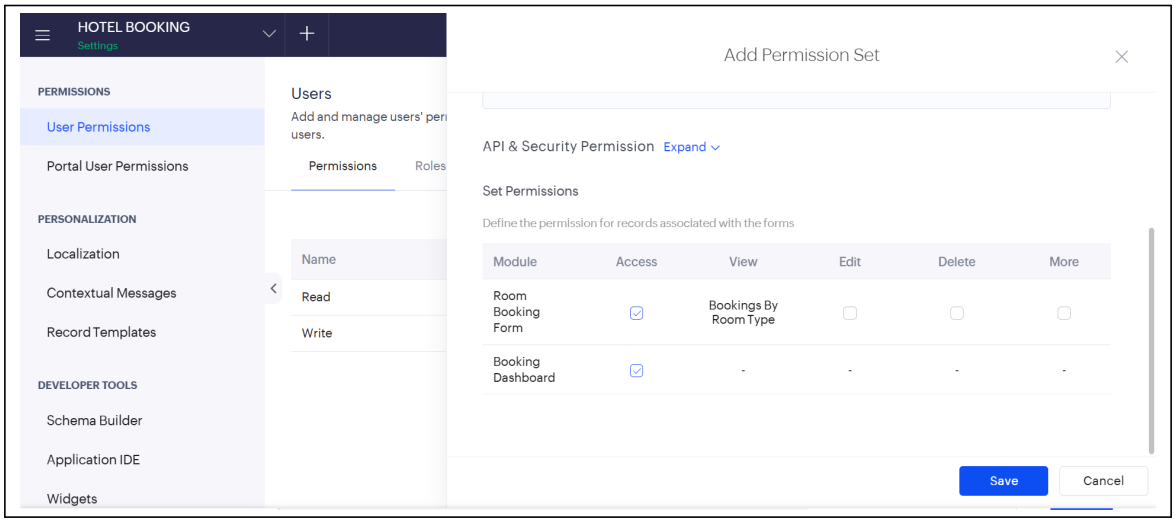


Figure 2: Add Permission Set dialog showing module-level Access, View, Edit, Delete and More rights

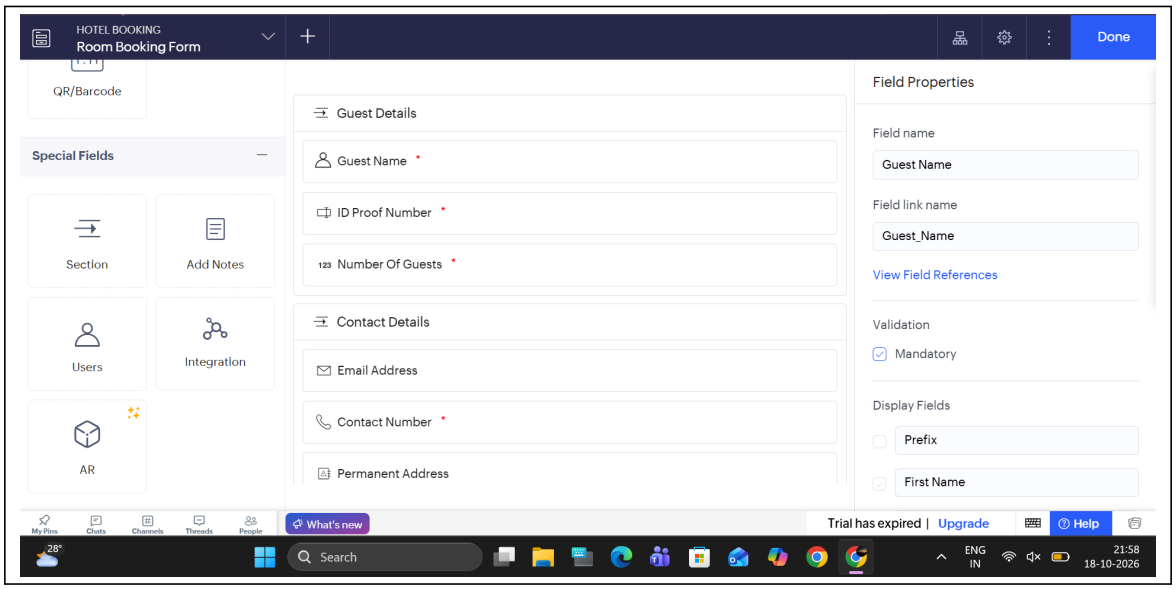


Figure 3: Form Builder: Field Properties of Guest Name with the Mandatory validation ticked

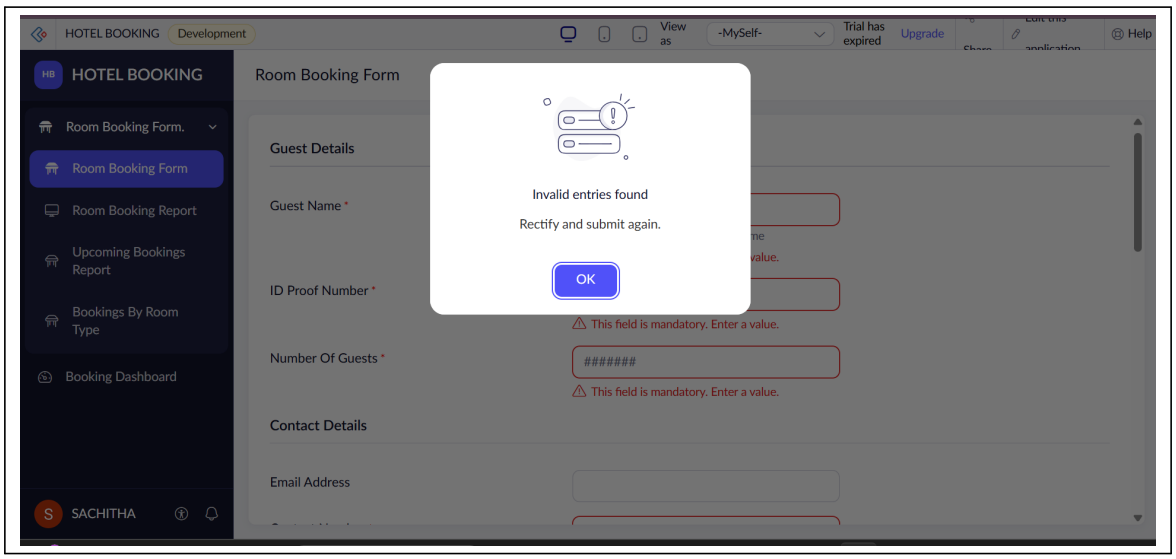


Figure 4: Form submission blocked when mandatory fields are empty

5. Expected Output

Only users with the right permission set can edit or delete bookings, incomplete submissions are rejected, and the environments keep development work separate from live use.

6. Result

Permission-based access control and mandatory-field validation were examined and demonstrated in the application. Private form links, field-level restriction, two-factor authentication and log review could not be executed in the lab account and are documented as guidelines.

7. Learning Outcome

Learnt how permission sets, validation rules and environment separation secure a Creator application, and which administration practices (private links, field restrictions, two-factor authentication, log review) complete a governance plan.